



Lakshmi Vijayan Nirmala

Junior Software Tester | Test Analyst | ISTQB CTFL 4.0

lakshmivijayannirmala@gmail.com

+44 7424682026

London, UK

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

ISTQB-certified QA Tester with hands-on experience in manual and exploratory testing within a highly regulated financial institution environment. Proven ability to design, execute and document structured test cycles including regression, smoke and integration testing with an unwavering focus on accuracy and compliance. Experienced in Agile sprint environments, supporting sprint task management and progress tracking via Jira and Confluence. Brings a data science background with Python proficiency, Linux/CLI exposure through Terraform-provisioned AWS environments, and familiarity with Playwright and pytest for automated testing. Committed to advocating for quality processes and continuous improvement.

KEY SKILLS

Testing Skills

- Manual & exploratory testing
- WAF rule testing & validation
- HTTP request testing with curl
- Expected vs actual result analysis
- Regression & smoke testing
- Integration Testing
- Test case creation, execution, management defect and reporting
- Agile sprint participation
- Performed API testing using Postman

Tools & Technologies

- curl (HTTP request testing)
- AWS CloudWatch (log review)
- AWS WAF (rule validation)
- Terraform environments (test execution)
- Amazon S3 (test environment)
- Exposure to Data Science & Analytics
- Exposure to Power BI & Tableau
- Exposure to playwright
- Jira and Confluence

Professional Skills

- Attention to detail
- Analytical & investigative thinking
- Clear written communication
- Stakeholder & developer collaboration
- Working in regulated/financial environments
- Documentation & recordkeeping
- Continuous improvement mindset

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Tester – AWS WAF Tuning Support | Dec 2025 – Present

Worked alongside a senior AWS WAF tuning engineer at a financial institution. Embedded within an Agile delivery team at a financial institution, responsible for manual testing, validation, evidence capture and structured reporting for WAF rule changes within AWS cloud environments. Operated to the strict compliance and audit standards required in regulated financial services.

Agile Participation & Sprint Support

- Actively supported Agile sprint ceremonies tracked new task creation, monitored progress, and maintained sprint boards in Jira and Confluence.
- Flagged testing dependencies and risks during sprint planning, contributing to more accurate delivery estimation.

WAF & API Testing

- Manually tested AWS WAF rule changes using curl to send HTTP requests and verify that rules correctly blocked malicious traffic while allowing legitimate requests through.
- Validated WAF behaviour against test scenarios defined by the WAF engineer, checking expected vs actual outcomes for each rule change.

- Tested within AWS environments provisioned via Terraform and S3, following the engineer's setup to execute test cases accurately.
- Re-ran tests after rule adjustments to confirm fixes and check for any unintended impact on other traffic patterns.

Log Analysis & Evidence Capture

- Reviewed AWS CloudWatch logs after each test to confirm whether traffic was blocked or allowed as expected, and to identify any anomalies.
- Captured screenshots of CloudWatch log outputs, curl responses, and test results to provide clear visual evidence for each test execution.
- Flagged unexpected log entries or results to the WAF engineer with supporting screenshots and notes for investigation.

Test Reporting & Documentation

- Produced structured test reports for each testing cycle, recording test cases executed, pass/fail results, evidence screenshots, and observations.
- Documented test findings clearly with steps to reproduce, expected vs actual results, and relevant log extracts to support the engineer's tuning decisions.
- Maintained organised records of all test activities and outcomes in line with financial institution audit and compliance requirements.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Project Assistant (Tourism, Government of Kerala, India) (03.10.2023 - 26.10.2024)

Supported planning and execution of large-scale government projects. Responsible for verifying documentation, proposals, reports, and budgets for accuracy and compliance. Monitored project progress, maintained status reports, and assisted with stakeholder presentations and RFP preparation.

District Programme Manager – DDU-GKY & Micro Enterprises (Govt of Kerala, India)(31.07.2017 - 07.02.2019)

Led programme implementation and monitoring across government initiatives. Managed MIS data reporting, conducted evaluations, and collaborated with multiple stakeholders to ensure quality delivery. Also oversaw micro enterprise development, training, and support programmes under the State Poverty Eradication Mission.

CERTIFICATIONS

ISTQB Certified Tester – Foundation Level (CTFL) 4.0 | International Software Testing Qualifications Board

EDUCATION

MBA SYSTEMS

College of Engineering Trivandrum, Kerala University India | 2014

Electronics & Communication Engineering

College of Engineering Kottarakkara CUSAT India | 2012
